them to the regents when required. Also he must keep an exact register of the clothes, and all other things which belong to those confined.

The regents assemble in the house at four o'clock every Wednesday afternoon, to collect and examine the transactions of the preceding week. They appoint a servant to give any necessary assistance to the father, to cut the slices of bread for the prisoners; and when the father is ill, in the evening to visit and examine the cots.

In the nine lower rooms of this house, in June 1778, were confined upwards of forty prisoners; in June 1781, fifty-five; in November, sixty-five; June 6, 1783, fifty-one. One of these was incapable of working, his limbs having been dislocated by torture. Each of these rooms, in which they work in the day and are locked up at night, contains at least four persons. The same prisoners do not continue long together, but are removed and separated once a fortnight or oftener. Few or none of them were rasping logwood, but most of them chopping it for the two mills belonging to the house: as it was found to be too laborious for most of the prisoners, to work with six or eight saws, which often weigh seventy or eighty pounds. The medical gentlemen, who daily visit the prison, informed the magistrates that it had been the cause of frequent ruptures.

No friends of the prisoners are permitted to visit them, without express orders from the regents, unless on Mondays: and then they must be searched, to prevent the introduction of spirituous liquors, or instruments for breaking out, or anything else forbidden: and they must retire before the time for shutting up. Every visitant is obliged to put two stivers into a box entrusted with the father. Refreshments may be received and given to the convicts on Tuesdays; but not on other days. Every evening, at eight o'clock, the father must see that all things are in due order. The saws, and other heavy implements for their work are taken from them in the evening, and returned in the morning. If a convict be guilty of breaking anything considerable, of burning the logwood, or of neglect or disobedience, he is punished severely by whipping, or confined to bread and water in a dungeon underground. On careful inquiry, I learned, that what has been said concerning a cellar in which such transgressors are put to pump or drown, is a fiction.

Prayers are read morning and evening, and before and after meals, by one of the best-behaved convicts: and divine service,

with a sermon, is performed in the chapel by a clergyman on Sunday mornings.

Once a year, a little before the change of the regency, the high-bailiff and magistrates, with a secretary, attended by the inferior officers of justice, come to this prison, in order to contract or lengthen the terms of confinement of the convicts, according to their good or bad behaviour, as represented by the regents.

The house provides for the prisoners, diet,[1] clothes, shoes and stockings, with shirts of half-bleached Flemish linen. Here is no infirmary: their labour keeps them in health: the physician, with whom I went the round at my last visit, had only two patients, and those with very slight disorders.

Some persons are confined in private rooms, to which none have access, unless in the presence of a regent. Great care is enjoined the father in conveying provisions to those prisoners. With the regent's leave, on Sunday mornings, some chapters of the Bible are read to them.[2]

The spin-house was for women. This, and the workhouse, were under the direction of six regents and four governesses;

[1] The diet of the convicts in the rasp-house at Amsterdam.

Sunday breakfast. Three slices of rye bread with butter, and a piece of dry bread six slices thick.

(N.B. Three slices weigh half a pound.)

Sunday dinner or noon. Half a pound of beef or pork, with beans, salt and vinegar, and in winter full two pounds of salt meat.

Monday breakfast. Six slices with butter, and a piece of bread of three slices thick.

Monday dinner. Grey peas with salt and vinegar.

Tuesday breakfast. As on Monday.

Tuesday dinner. White or grey peas boiled in water with salt and sage.

Wednesday breakfast. As on Monday.

Wednesday dinner. Boiled oats or barley with sweet milk and butter upon it.

Wednesday supper. Buttermilk, with oats or barley boiled in it.

Thursday breakfast. Six slices of rye bread with butter, and a piece of bread as on Sunday morning.

Thursday dinner. Stockfish, with sweet milk and butter upon it.

Friday. As Tuesday.

Saturday breakfast. As Tuesday.

Saturday dinner. As Wednesday supper.

Their drink is four pints of beer daily. But on holidays, viz., two days at Easter, Ascension-day, two at Whitsuntide, three at the fair time, and two at Christmas, they have for dinner, smoked or salt meat or bacon, beans or peas, carrots or cabbage, and the three fair days they have strong beer.

[2] There are many of these rooms, or houses of confinement in Holland, called Verbeterhuizen. The regulations of some of them I collected; but as they are liable to abuse, and contrary to the general notions of public justice, I cannot but wish that they were universally suppressed.